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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture



(<https://doa.gov.lk/>)

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நெல் ஆராய்ச்சி அபிவிருத்தி நிறுவனம் - பதலகொட்டை
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RICE IN SRI LANKA RICE DISEASES

False smut

Causative agent

Fungus, *Ustilaginoidea virens*

Plant parts and life stages affected

Mature panicle and grains

Symptoms

This disease is considered as an omen of a good harvest, as the factors that favour this disease will also favour a good yield.

Disease symptoms start to show when the grains get mature. When the grains are full, the pericarp splits a little bit, which facilitates the causative agent to enter and develop.

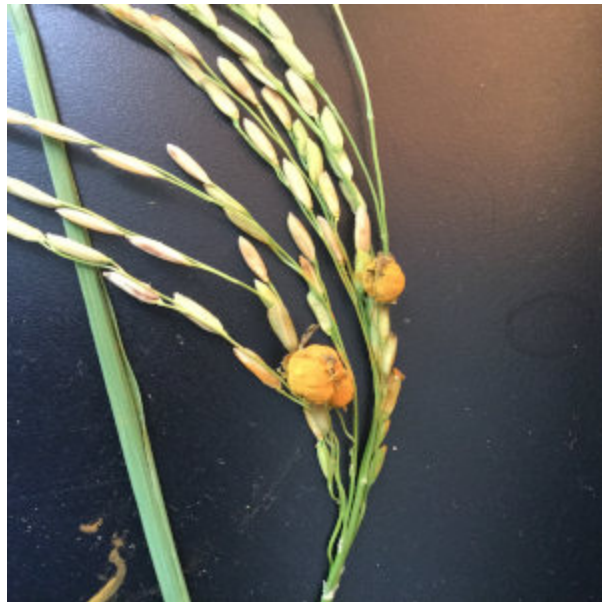
Seed coat remains green while inside the grain, the disease develops forming a large orange to brown-green fruiting structures

This could be observed in one or more grains of the mature panicle.

Later the orange covering ruptures exposing a mass of greenish-black spores

The grain is then replaced by one or more sclerotia.





Conditions that favour the disease

Environmental temperatures within 25-35 °C

High humidity

Rain and winds during flowering stage

Excessive use of nitrogen fertilizer

Higher plant density

Weeds

Susceptible varieties

Bw 367, Bg 403

Disease Management

Within the crop season

[Application of urea in recommended dosages or application of urea based
\(../rrdi_fertilizerrecomendation\) on leaf colour chart
\(../rrdi_div_soilscience_leafcolorchart\).](#)

[Water management](#) (../rrdi_watermanagement)

**If the crop is infected, following management options should be applied for the
next season**

Use of certified seed paddy free from the disease

[Weed management](#) (../rrdi_riceweeds)

Addition of burnt paddy husk (253 kg per acre) to the soil during land
preparation.

Abstain addition of disease infected.

[Water management](#) (../rrdi_watermanagement)

Maintaining an average level plant population in the field

